GIS Layers · Reading Place

LAUNCH · Humanities · 40 minutes

I can select and combine GIS layers at two scales to produce and qualify an evidence-based place description.

Name: ____________________________ Date: _______________

You may write, type, say, sign, point or direct a partner. An adult can read the words and record your exact response. Keep the choice and explanation your own.

We do · make a choice and give a reason

Commit before reveal: Which sentence best describes the situation of a place?

- The site occupies mostly flat land.
- It lies east of the centre and is linked to it by a bridge and rail corridor.
- Retail is the dominant land use.

My choice and the evidence I used:

Resources and independent record

LAUNCH Humanities · Week 9 of 14 40 minutes · Aut2·W2 · Use digital mapping/GIS to describe a place

Enquiry: What can GIS reveal about a place—and what does it hide?

Learning objective: I can select and combine GIS layers at two scales to produce and qualify an evidence-based place description.

Vocabulary: GIS · layer · site · situation · scale · proximity · connectivity · distribution

CONSTRUCTED CLASSROOM RESOURCE: This fictional composite is inspired by the broad Teesside setting. It is not official data, is not to scale and must not be used for navigation, safety or real-world planning.

Week 9 evidence pack · Teesbridge Quarter

Scale 1 metadata: ↑ N · fictional 2025 classroom snapshot · coordinates A1–E5 · each cell is one comparative unit, not a real distance or navigational scale.

A1 River	B1 River	C1 River	D1 River + industry	E1 River + industry
A2 Base land	B2 Base land	C2 Base land	D2 Bridge + industry	E2 Industry
A3 Rail	B3 Rail	C3 Centre + station	D3 Rail	E3 Rail
A4 Housing	B4 Housing + clinic	C4 College + road	D4 Green	E4 Green
A5 Housing	B5 Housing	C5 Road	D5 Green	E5 Green

Layer	Mapped evidence in the fictional 5×5 model	Evidence limit
Base	River along the north edge; bridge at D2; centre/station at C3.	No real-world distance scale.
Transport	Rail corridor runs west–east through C3; a north–south road meets it.	Frequency, cost and journey time are absent.
Land use	Industry clusters north-east; housing south-west; green space south-east.	Dominant use hides mixed use and quality.
Services	Clinic at B4 and college at C4, close to housing and the centre.	Capacity, opening times and accessibility are absent.

Layer	Mapped evidence in the fictional 5×5 model	Evidence limit
Environment	Mapped green space clusters south-east.	Presence does not show public access or condition.

Scale 2 • wider fictional corridor overview

Teesbridge Quarter sits on the middle river corridor, 4 classroom-km east of Hillford Interchange and 6 classroom-km west of Port Reach. The regional rail/road route follows the valley; a broad green belt lies south of the corridor. These are comparative classroom distances, not real measurements.

Six statement cards • sort by site / situation

The settlement occupies riverside land.

Housing clusters in the south-west of the mapped area.

Green/open land clusters in the south-east.

The centre is linked west–east by a rail corridor.

The industrial zone lies close to the bridge and river.

The clinic and college lie near housing and the centre.

Two-scale prompt: Which claim survives when the view changes from the Quarter grid to the wider corridor?

Evidence boundary: Teacher-approved/licensed sources retain title, author/producer, date, origin, scale and rights/use. No personal/family location or migration disclosure is required.

Independent evidence • Week 9

Supported

Sort six prepared statements into site or situation, complete a four-sentence description using two layers, then add one sentence from the wider corridor view.

Available support: Supported access: layer key, site/situation sorter and Locate → Layer → Link → Limit headings.

Standard

Write a place evidence brief with location, two patterns, a layer relationship, one limitation and one claim that survives, changes or becomes less certain at the wider scale.

Available support: Standard scaffold: claim → mapped detail → comparison → limitation.

Stretch

Judge which two layers are most useful for locating a fictional clinic; reject one layer and explain uncertainty.

Available support: Stretch scaffold: weigh layer usefulness across two scales and reject a plausible alternative.

Response

Evidence → judgement → limitation

My decision / product:

Evidence I used:

Counter-evidence, anomaly or limitation:

Response route: written/typed verbal/recorded annotated/map scribed exact words

Exit: Name the strongest layer for the enquiry, one pattern it reveals and one thing it cannot prove.

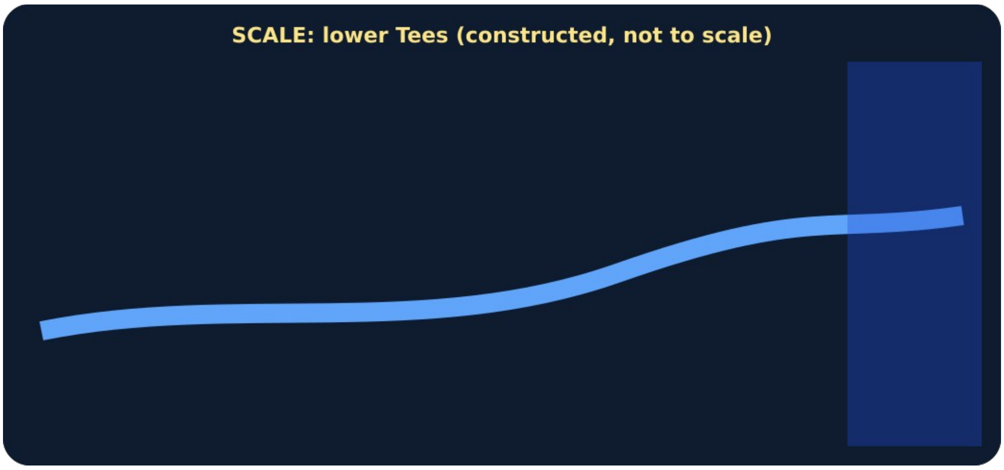
Paper route • discuss the lesson choices

Use these choices with the matching teaching stage. Point to or number a choice, explain it, then revisit it after feedback. The original HTML keeps the live controls.

- river + sea
- housing
- roads + rail
- industry / port
- flood risk
- zoom to one neighbourhood
- Claim A: people live near transport because it is convenient
- Claim B: the housing layer shows a cluster near transport; the reason needs other evidence
- Base / reset
- Transport
- Land use
- Services
- Environment

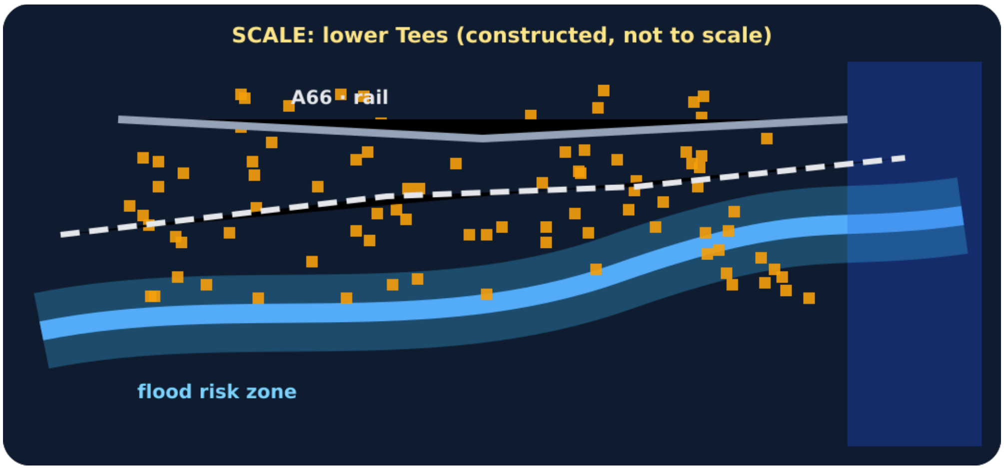
Choice / card	My reason or evidence	My revision after feedback

Visual evidence from the lesson

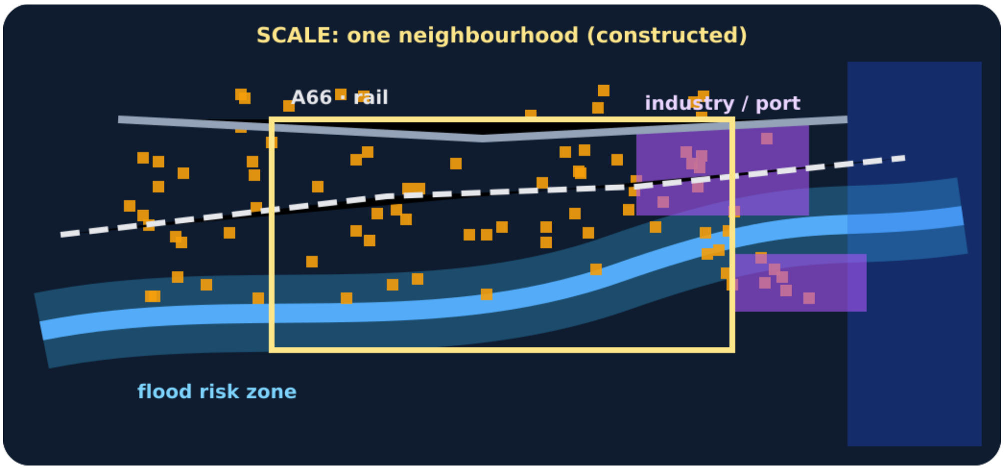


Base layer: river and sea only

Housing and transport layers added



Flood-risk layer added



All layers with a zoom box

Layered schematic GIS map

Exit • one next step

After the adult has listened, what will you keep, improve or check next?